

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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Finding reasoning paths:

- 1. Persistent sadness and hopelessness -> Major depressive disorder (MDD)
- 2. Suicidal ideations and guilt -> Major depressive disorder (MDD)
- 3. Short-term behavioral changes (worsening suicidal ideations, guilt) -> Major depressive disorder (MDD)

Reasoning Process:

- 1. **Persistent Sadness and Hopelessness:** The patient reports feeling sad for as long as he can remember, which is indicative of persistent depressive symptoms. This symptomatology is commonly associated with Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). MDD is characterized by a persistent mood of sadness or loss of interest in activities that were once enjoyed.
- 2. **Suicidal Ideations and Guilt:** The patient expresses severe suicidal ideations and guilt over past problems. These are hallmark symptoms of MDD, especially when they occur alongside a loss of hope or feelings of worthlessness. These symptoms align with the depressive phase of the disorder.
- 3. **Short-Term Behavioral Changes:** The worsening of suicidal ideations and guilt over the past two weeks are short-term but severe, which is consistent with the acute depressive episode often seen in MDD. The acute onset of these symptoms suggests a rapid onset of depression, which is sometimes seen in MDD.

Conclusion:

Based on the reasoning process, the most likely diagnosis for the patient is Major Depressive Disorder (MDD), given the persistent depressive symptoms, suicidal ideations, and acute worsening of depressive symptoms over a short period.

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<answer>
The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
</answer>